WEBSITE DOCUMENTATION · 15 OCTOBER 2026

# Thirteen *Pieces*

A one-page interactive portfolio. Visitors walk a small hooded wanderer through a dusk landscape and discover thirteen objects. Each object is a student project.




| 13 | 9 | 4 | I |
|---|---|---|---|
| pieces along the path | projects placed | spots kept open | self-contained HTML file |

OVERVIEW

## A portfolio you walk through

The site borrows the feeling of Wayfinder, the National Film Board of Canada's game of poetry and animated exploration across the land. Instead of a grid of thumbnails, projects are found by moving through a place.

Each piece shows only three things: the project name, the person who made it, and the GitHub link they supplied. No project repositories were edited, and no descriptions were written on anyone's behalf, so nothing about a project is misstated.

The first piece, **DACian Era by Aabha**, is the worked example. Its card carries a second button to the live site at dacian-era-cglt.onrender.com, showing how any project can link to its deployed version.

The live page is hosted at claude.ai/artifact/FnXnFCtC4PHZ8mAjN34oZS. It is private until shared from its Share menu.

USING IT

# Walk close, then open

A piece's name lights up when the wanderer is within reach. Opening it brings up a paper card with the project's links.

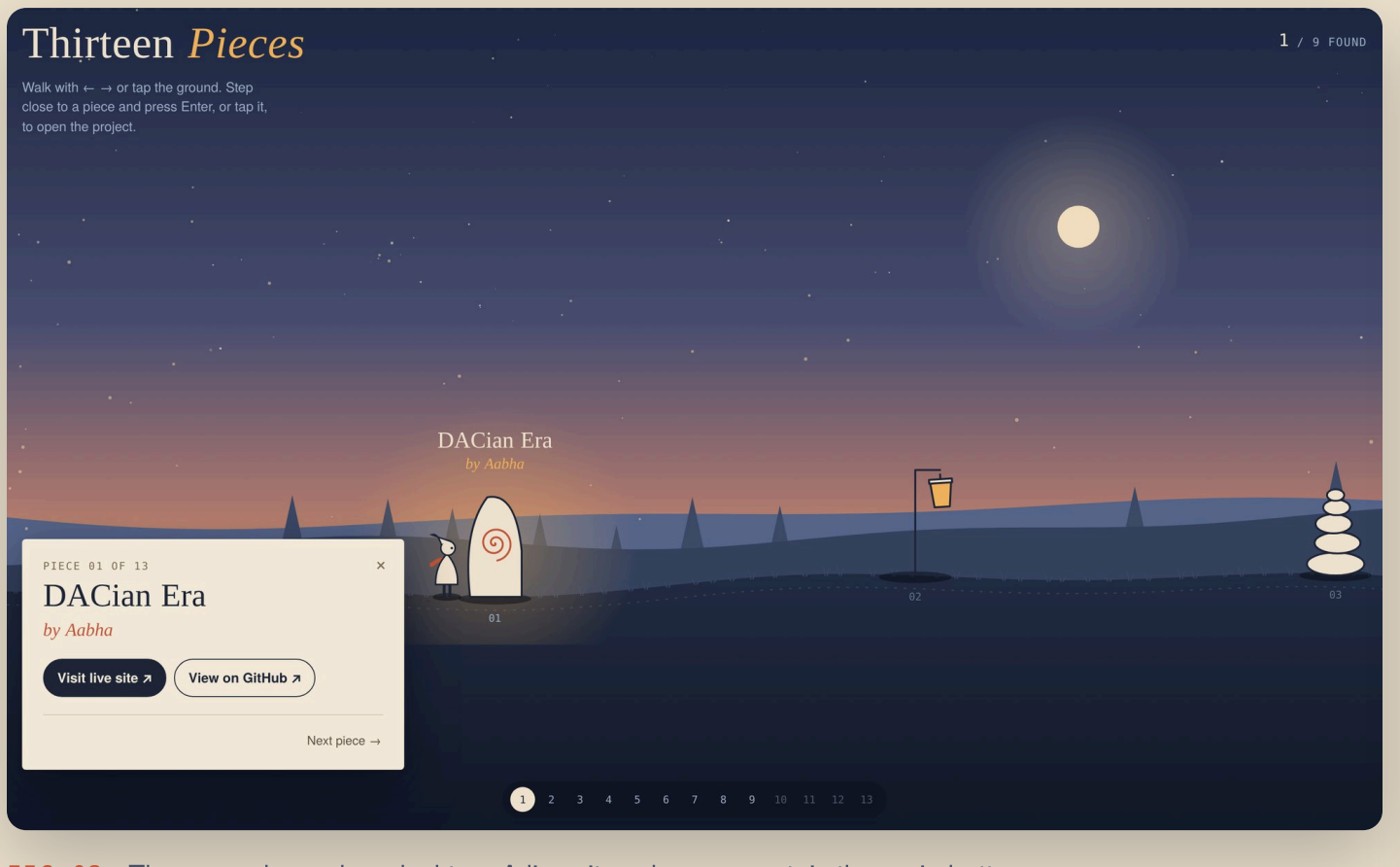



FIG 02 The example card on desktop. A live site, when present, is the main button.




FIG 03 On a phone the card spans the screen and the piece stays visible above it.

| ACTION | DESKTOP | PHONE OR TABLET |
|---|---|---|
| **Walk** | ← → arrow keys, or A / D | Tap the ground; the wanderer walks there |
| **See a name** | Walk within reach of a piece; its title and maker fade in above it | Same |
| **Open a card** | Enter, Space or E when near, or click the piece | Tap the piece; it walks over first if far away |
| **Jump anywhere** | Click a number in the bottom strip | Tap a number in the bottom strip |
| **Next project** | Previous / Next on the card | Same |
| **Close** | Esc, the × button, or walk away | ×, or tap elsewhere |

The counter at the top right shows how many of the nine projects a visitor has opened. Opened numbers turn amber in the bottom strip, and this is remembered in that visitor's browser.

THE PATH

# Thirteen objects, one landscape

Pieces stand 440 px apart along a dotted path. Each project gets its own hand-drawn object, and four dashed outlines hold places for projects still to come.

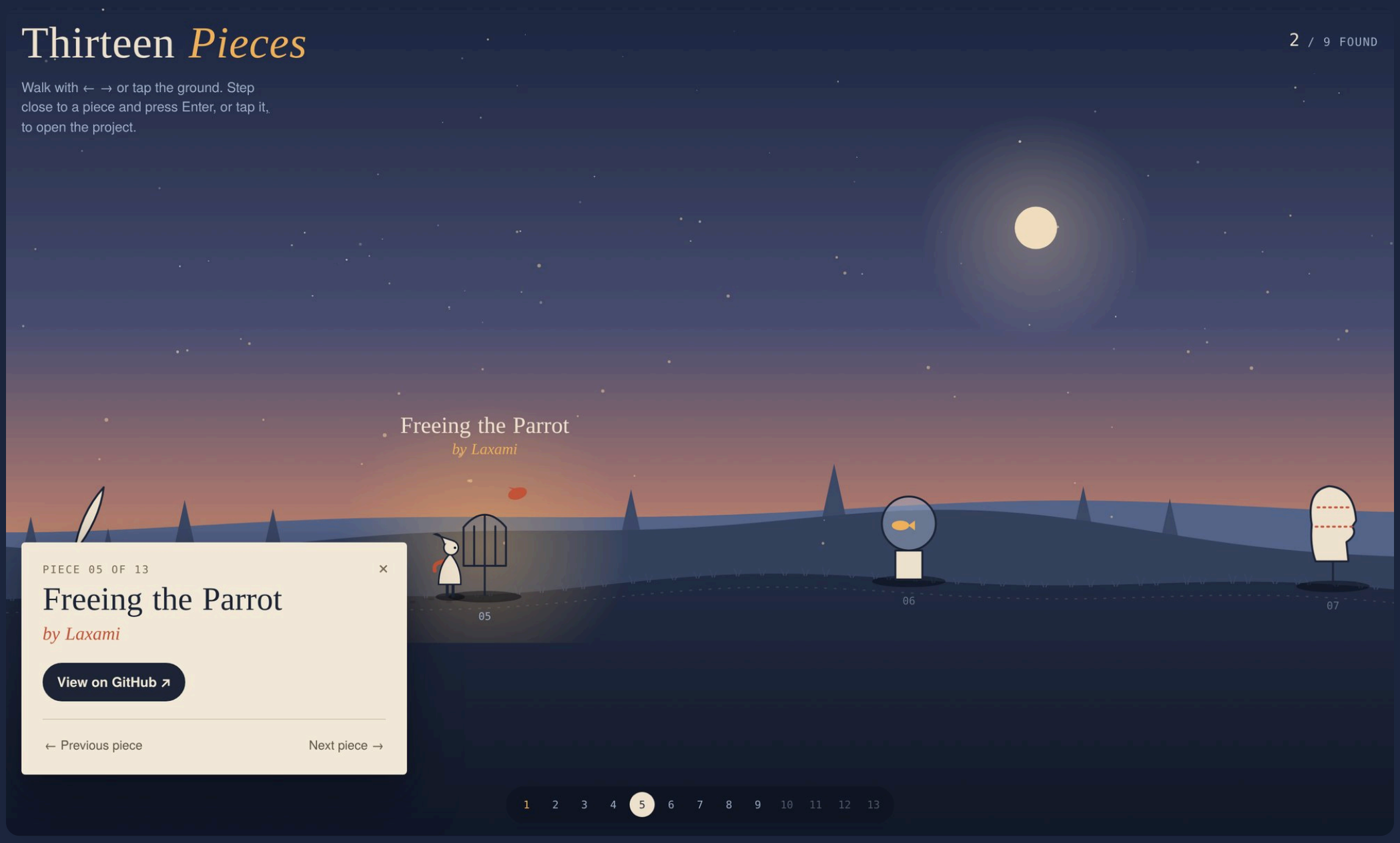



FIG 04 A card with only a repository link. Behind it, the cage, goldfish bowl and profile head are three of the nine object designs.

- **Standing stone** with a carved spiral
- **Cairn** of stacked stones
- **Open cage** with a bird flying free
- **Profile head** marked with measuring lines
- **Arch** sending out echo rings
- **Lantern** that sways on its pole
- **Writing stand** with a moving quill
- **Goldfish bowl** with a swimming fish
- **Tree** with a hanging letter
- **Open spot**: a dashed outline and a question mark

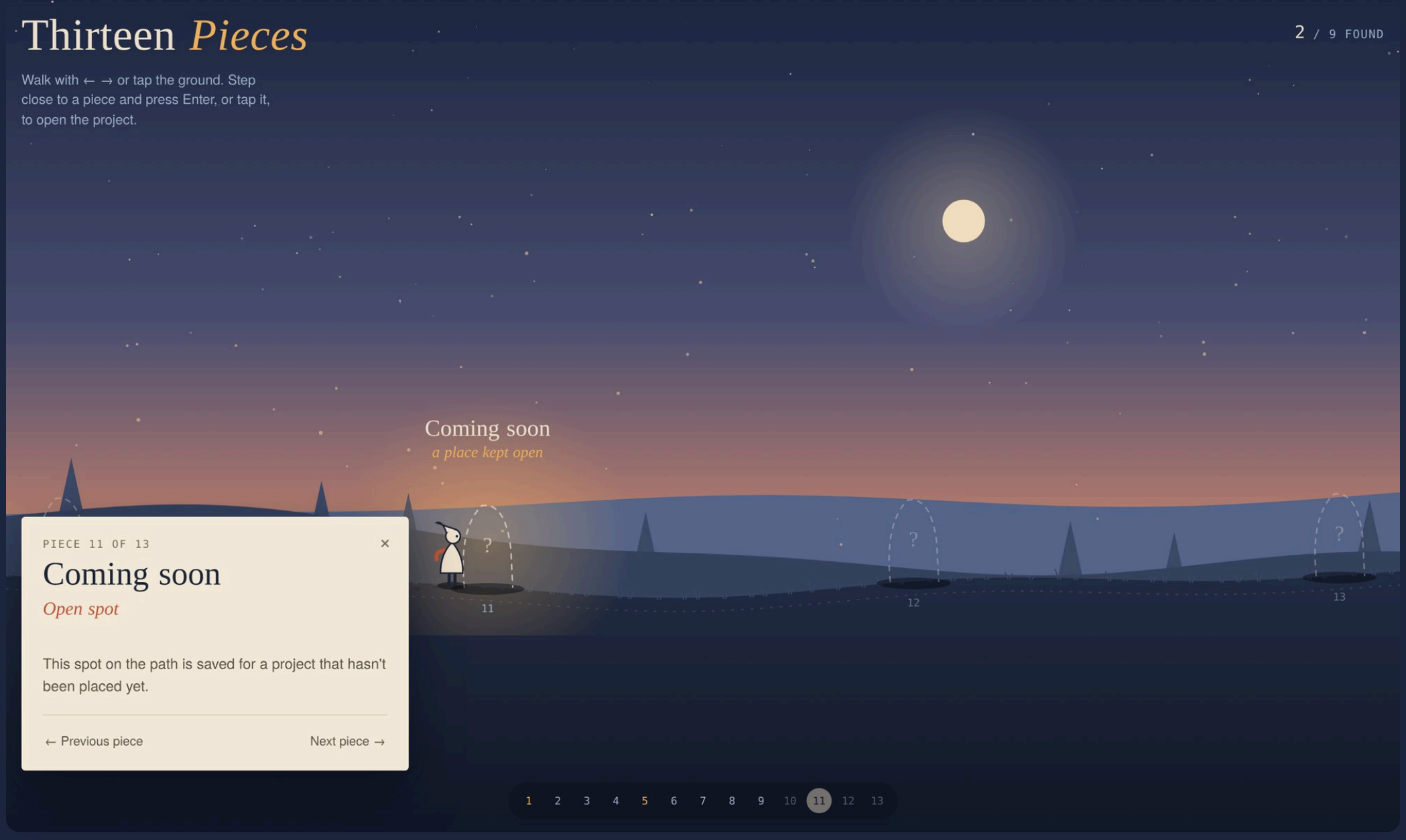



FIG 05 Pieces 10 to 13 are open spots. Their cards read "Coming soon" until a project is placed there.

DESIGN

# One committed dusk scene

Cream objects lit by an amber glow stand against layered blue hills. The card is the one bright, paper-coloured surface, made for reading.

| Night sky | Horizon | Far hills | Cream pieces | Ember glow | Rust detail |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| #1d2740 | #d79a70 | #56658a | #efe3cf | #f0b25c | #c4553a |

DISPLAY

IM Fell English

Site title, project names, maker names

BODY

Karla

Instructions and buttons

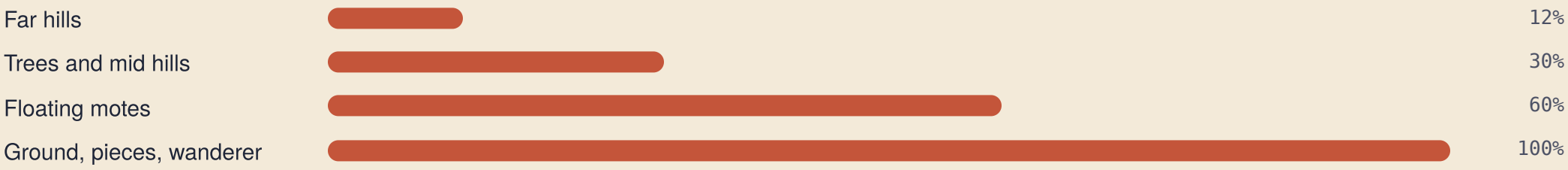
UTILITY

DM Mono

Piece numbers, counter, labels

## Depth through parallax

Each layer of the landscape scrolls at its own speed as the camera follows the wanderer, which gives the scene depth.



## The wanderer

A cream cloak with a pointed hood and a rust scarf that trails behind and lengthens as it walks. Its legs swing in step and it leaves footprints that fade after five seconds.

## Motion

Pieces glow when the wanderer is near, and the name fades in above. Small loops keep each object alive: the lantern sways, the bird flaps, the fish swims, the arch sends out rings. All of it stops when a visitor's system asks for reduced motion.

BUILD

# How it is built

The whole site is one HTML file with no libraries. The landscape is drawn on a canvas every frame, and the header, path strip and card are ordinary HTML laid over it. The only outside request is Google Fonts.

## Parts of the page

| PART | WHAT IT IS | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|---|
| `#world` | Full-screen canvas | Sky, hills, ground, pieces, wanderer, labels |
| `.hud` | Header | Title, instructions, found counter |
| `.path` | Strip of 13 numbered buttons | Jump to any piece; marks the current and opened pieces |
| `#card` | Paper card | Piece number, project name, maker, links, previous and next |

## Every frame, about 60 times a second

01

Read the keys or the tap target and move the wanderer, easing its speed.

02

Move the camera to keep the wanderer a third of the way across the screen.

03

Find the nearest piece within 95 px and mark it in the strip.

04

Draw back to front: sky, hills, trees, motes, ground, footprints, pieces, wanderer, labels.

## Key functions

| FUNCTION | ROLE |
|---|---|
| `update(dt)` | Movement, camera, nearest-piece check, closing the card when the wanderer walks away |
| `drawPiece()` | Draws one of the nine object designs, or the dashed open spot |
| `wanderer(t)` | Draws the character with its walk cycle and scarf |
| `label()` | Title and maker above the nearby piece |
| `open(i)` / `close()` | Fill and show, or hide, the project card |
| `walkTo(i)` | Walk to a piece and open it on arrival |

## Saved state

Which pieces a visitor has opened is kept in that visitor's browser under the key `tp-seen`. It is not shared between visitors or devices, and the page works normally when it can't be saved.

UPDATING

# Everything lives in one list

All project details sit in the `PROJECTS` list near the top of the script. Position on the path, the number and the object drawn are worked out from each entry's place in the list.

## Fill an open spot

Replace one `{soon:true}` with a new entry:

```
{maker:"Name", title:"Project name", repo:"https://github.com/…"},
```

## Add a live site

Add a `live` field to any entry. The card then shows "Visit live site" as its main button, with GitHub beside it:

```
{maker:"Name", title:"Project name", repo:"https://github.com/…", live:"https://…"},
```

## Add more pieces or reorder

Add entries to the end of the list and the path grows by 440 px per piece, with the object designs cycling through the nine shapes. Moving entries within the list moves their numbers, positions and shapes with them. If the count changes, update the title in `<title>` and the header.

KNOWN ISSUES

# Two ways visitors can miss the portfolio

Neither issue is fixed yet. Both affect whether every project gets seen.

| ISSUE | WHY IT HAPPENS | POSSIBLE FIX |
|---|---|---|
| **Visitors may not reach every project** | The path is a single line walked from left to right. People spend most of their time on the first few pieces, so later projects get far fewer visits, and the order of the list decides who gets seen. | Shuffle the start position or order on each visit; show an overview map of all 13 pieces up front; nudge visitors on with "8 projects still to find". |
| **No way back to the portfolio** | Project links open the project's own site in a new tab. Those sites have no link back to Thirteen Pieces, so a visitor who keeps browsing there may not return. | Ask each maker to add a "Back to Thirteen Pieces" link on their site; remind visitors on the card that the portfolio stays open in the previous tab. |

The bottom number strip already eases the first issue, since any piece can be reached in one click.

ACCESSIBILITY AND LIMITS

# Every project, with or without the walk

The bottom strip is a row of real buttons, each labelled with the piece number, project and maker. Keyboard and screen-reader users can open any card without playing.

- **Keyboard.** Tab reaches the strip and card buttons, with a visible amber focus ring. Esc closes the card.
- **Small screens.** Instructions hide under 520 px wide, the card spans the screen, and walking is by tap.
- **Links.** Project links open in a new tab. Other sites can't be embedded inside the card.
- **Reduced motion.** Stars, motes, swaying and the card's rise stop when the system asks for less motion.
- **Privacy.** The page is private until shared; only people given access can open it.
- **Content.** Cards show only names, project names and the links each person provided.

Stills in this document were captured in a headless browser with stand-in typefaces; the live site uses IM Fell English, Karla and DM Mono.